Trading Strategy Lab

Functional specification, implementation, deployment, and testing

Final project report | Version 1.1 | 10 October 2026

Executive summary

Trading Strategy Lab turns a strategy write-up into a versioned Markdown document, reviews it with Indian options charges, and trades only a frozen copy of a version a person has approved. The Review Crew runs inside the API. The Trade Crew runs as a separate process. Paper and Sandbox are the broker adapters in this repository. No exchange broker ships here.

A markets screen shows delayed quotes and candle charts from Yahoo Finance and accepts manual paper orders with Indian charges. Those orders are separate from the Trade Crew.

Three databases keep the records. The research database stores strategies, reports, simulated trades, reviews, manual paper orders, and a hash-chained audit log. The live database stores approvals, orders, fills, credentials, and its own audit log. The market database stores NSE end-of-day prices, events, and headlines, and it is not audited.

An LLM may extract a strategy, explain a proposal, or comment on an entry the rules already approved. It does not open or close a trade. A veto, when explicitly enabled, can only skip or shrink that entry.

This report states the behaviour the current code implements. It does not add service-level percentages the repository does not measure.

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1 Problem statement and objectives

Business problem

A retail options idea usually arrives as a video, a caption, a note, or Markdown. Rewriting it into rules, costing the trades, and then placing orders that still match the reviewed text is a manual process. The write-up and the orders can diverge, and a later edit can erase the version that was approved.

Proposed solution

The lab ingests the source, stores each strategy version, and runs a Review Crew over backtest and forward windows. Approval copies one version into the live database with its content hash and rules hash. A Trade Crew ticks that frozen copy.

If the hashes no longer match, the deployment halts.

Stakeholders

Stakeholder	Need	What the system stores
Strategy author	Turn a source into rules	`ingest_runs`, `strategy_versions`, Gaps
Reviewer	See net results after costs	`reports`, `sim_trades`, `trade_reviews`
Operator	Approve one version and watch it	`deployed_strategies`, deployments, heartbeats
Risk owner	Cap loss, drawdown, and size	Frozen `risk_limits`, drawdown and capital events

Objectives and boundaries

The objectives are an auditable version history, a costed review, and orders that come from the approved rules. The scenario verdict is not evidence that the strategy's own `rules:` block made money. That replay is the approval backtest. Live trading still needs a registered live-capable broker. Paper and Sandbox are the adapters in this tree. Sandbox live mode exists only when `SANDBOX_ALLOW_LIVE=true`, and it does not send orders to an exchange.

2 Functional specification

ID	Function	Required behaviour
FR01	Ingest	Accept youtube, instagram, document (HTML), notebooklm, or markdown. Reject PDF URLs.
FR02	Extract	Produce Markdown with a `rules:` block. Unexpressed rules go into Gaps. Do not invent thresholds. Return clarifying questions; answers re-extract from the stored source into a new version.
FR03	Review	Run audit, scenarios, simulation, hard-stop sweep, per-trade review, verdict, and improvements.
FR04	Journal	List simulated and live trades with entry reason, target, net, and outcome.
FR05	Improvements	Record accepted, rejected, or applied. Applied saves a new strategy version.
FR06	Archive	Soft-delete a strategy. The row stays.
FR07	Approve	Freeze one version onto a broker account. Refuse when rules fail, Gaps remain, or the hash confirmation does not match.
FR08	Trade	Tick only while the deployment is started. Rules in code decide entries and exits.
FR09	Kill switch	Stop first, then cancel working orders. Flatten, which closes positions, requires an API token.
FR10	Audit	Append a hash-chained event for research writes and for live writes. Expose a verify route for each chain.
FR11	Markets	Show delayed quotes and candles. Place manual paper orders with charges and net them into positions. Commodities are view-only.

The dashboard is `/`. Markets is `/markets`. The lab is `/lab`. Deploy is `/deploy`. Deployments is `/deployments`.

3 Security and interface contracts

Authentication

API_TOKENS holds name:sha256(token) pairs. A valid Bearer token sets the audit actor and ignores X-Actor. An invalid token is 401. When API_TOKENS is empty, research and paper mutating routes accept X-Actor, which is not authenticated.

These actions return 403 until a token exists, even if API_TOKENS is empty: broker credentials, creating a live account, live approval, live start, live veto, live capital events, and stop with flatten.

CORS_ORIGINS=* is refused at startup when any token is configured.

Broker secrets are Fernet ciphertext under BROKER_CREDENTIALS_KEY. API responses and audit details store a fingerprint, not the value.

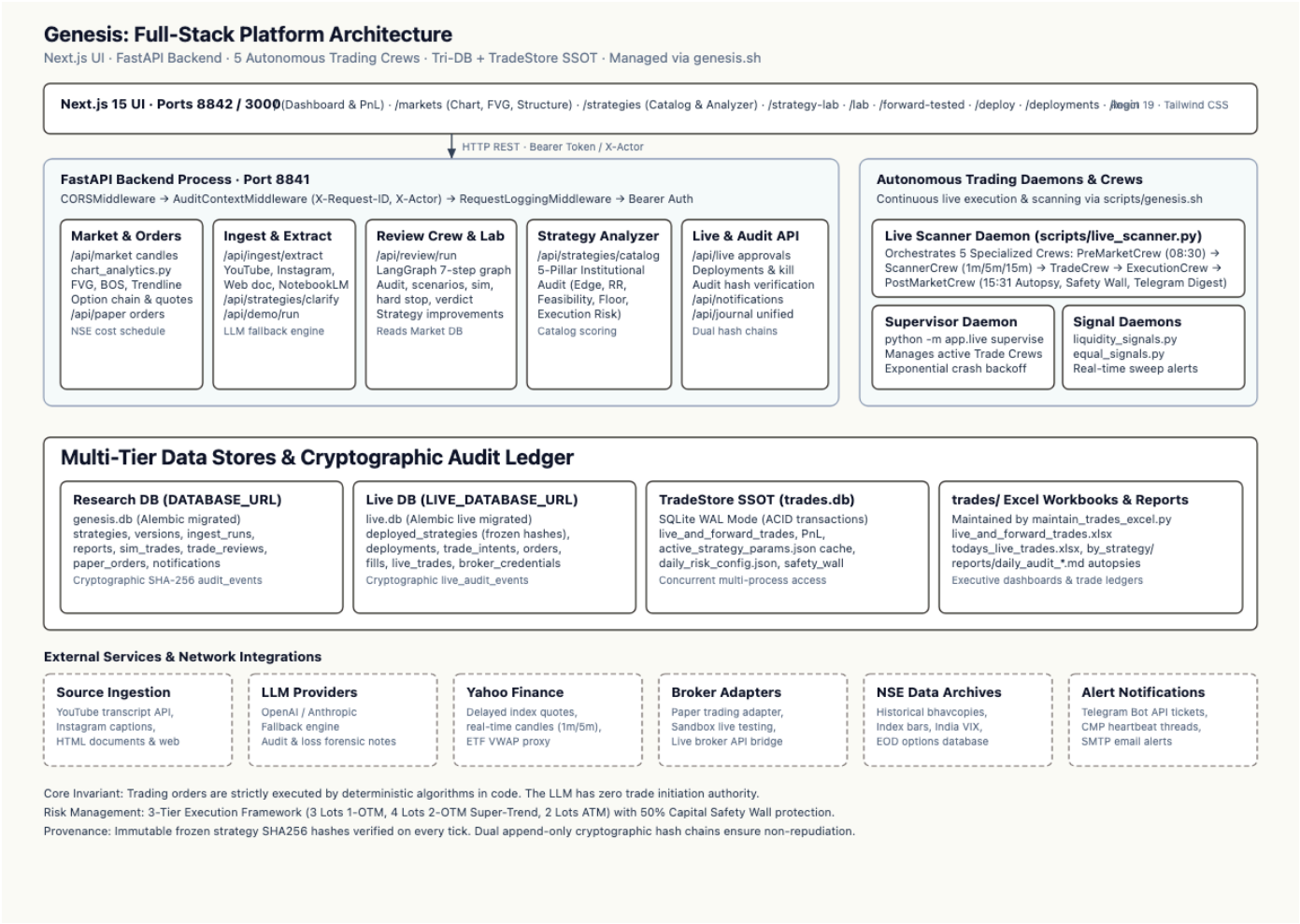
Principal API contracts

Method and path	Contract
GET /api/health	Liveness.
POST /api/ingest/extract	Extract a strategy and store the ingest run.
POST /api/ingest/clarify	Re-extract with the author's answers. Needs an LLM key and an ingested version.
POST /api/review/run	Run the Review Crew and store the report.
POST /api/demo/run	Run the bundled fixture.
GET /api/journal	Merge simulated and live trades.
GET /api/audit/verify	Recompute the research hash chain.
GET /api/market/quotes, GET /api/market/candles	Delayed Yahoo data. 400 for an unknown symbol.
POST /api/paper/orders	Record a manual paper order with charges.
GET /api/paper/positions	Positions netted from paper orders, marked at the latest quote.
GET /api/live/approvals/preview	Rules, hash, blockers, verdict.
POST /api/live/approvals/backtest	Rules only versus rules with policy and ladder.
POST /api/live/approvals	Freeze the version and create the deployment.
POST /api/live/deployments/{id}/start	Start from approved or paused.
POST /api/live/deployments/{id}/stop	Kill switch. flatten: true closes positions.
GET /api/live/audit/verify	Recompute the live hash chain.

Live reads return 503 until alembic -n live upgrade head has been applied. The full route list is in backend/README.md.

4 System architecture

The browser talks only to FastAPI. FastAPI fetches quotes and candles from Yahoo Finance per request. The Review Crew runs in that process. The Trade Crew does not. A supervisor starts one crew subprocess per started deployment.



Research, live, and market data are three databases. Approval copies the strategy text and hashes into the live database. It does not foreign-key back to research.

`vendor/TradingAgents` is not imported. Langfuse keys in `.env.example` are not read.

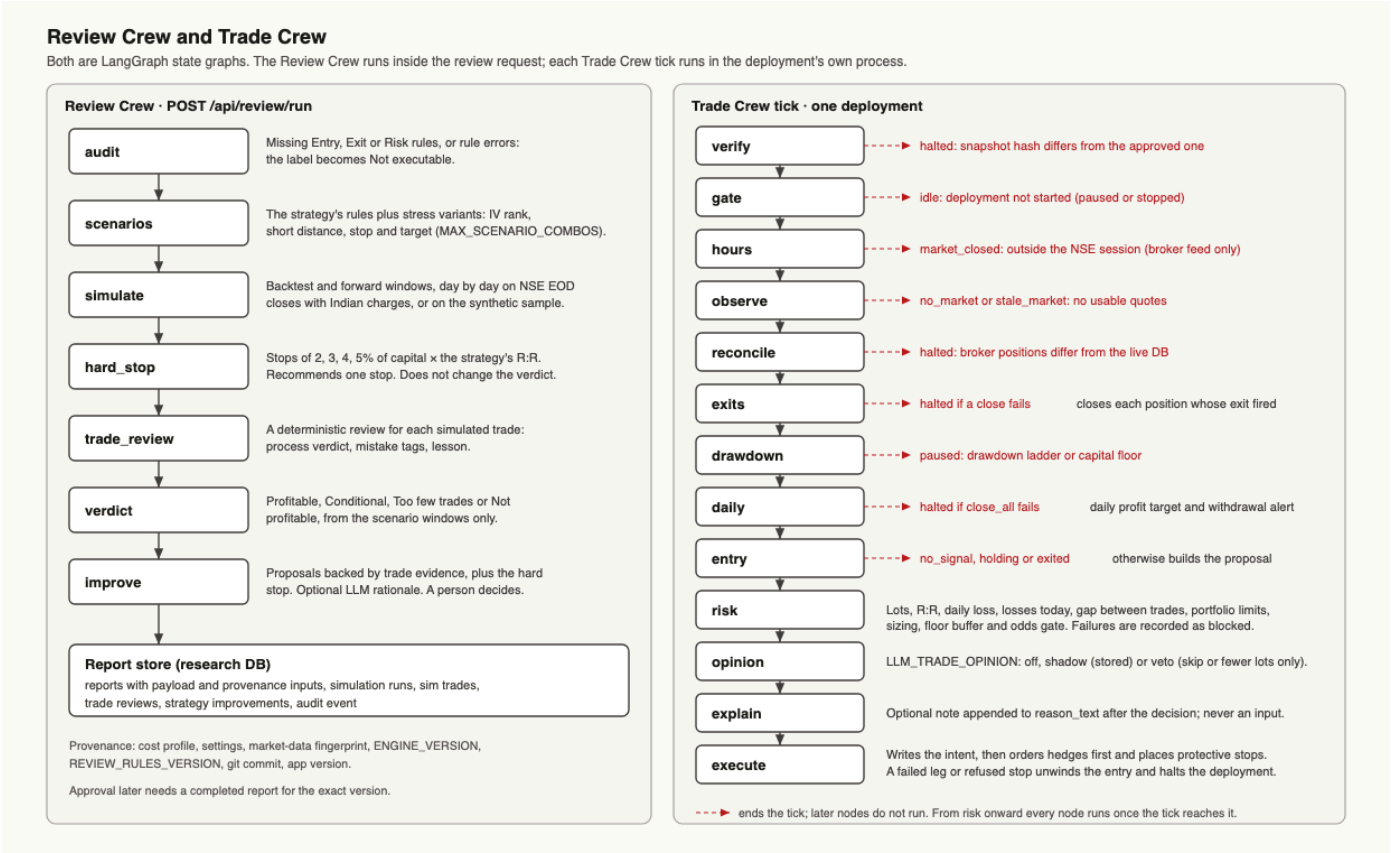
5 Implementation design

Technology	Role
FastAPI and Uvicorn	HTTP API and OpenAPI
Pydantic and pydantic-settings	Requests and `Settings`
SQLAlchemy 2 and Alembic	Research and live schemas. Market tables use `create_all`
LangGraph	Review Crew and Trade Crew graphs
LangChain OpenAI or Anthropic	The one provider selected by `LLM_PROVIDER`
HTTPX, Beautiful Soup, lxml	HTML ingest. HTTPX also fetches Yahoo market data
youtube-transcript-api	YouTube transcripts
cryptography	Fernet for broker credentials
Next.js 15, React 19, Tailwind 4	Dashboard, markets, lab, deploy, and deployments pages
lightweight-charts	Candle charts on the markets page

Technology	Role
pytest	Backend tests. No test calls a real LLM or a real broker

There is no vector store, no Auth0, and no separate metrics service.

6 Workflows



Review order is fixed: audit, scenarios, simulate, hard-stop sweep, trade review, verdict, improve. The sweep can propose a capital stop. It does not set `verdict_label`. The label is `Not executable`, `Profitable`, `Conditional`, `Too few trades`, or `Not profitable`.

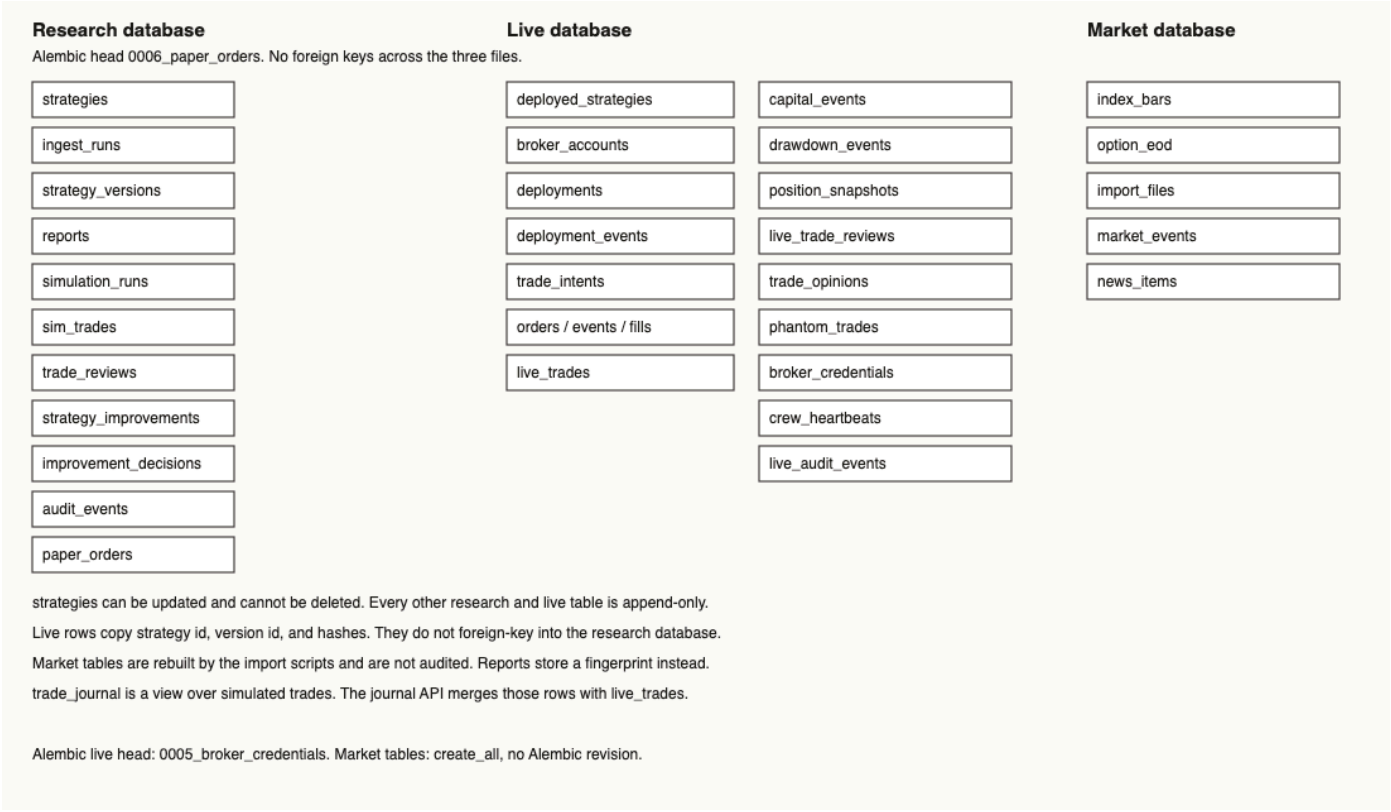
A Trade Crew tick verifies the frozen hashes, checks that the deployment is started, checks market hours on the broker feed, observes, reconciles, exits, applies drawdown and the capital floor, then considers an entry. Once an entry is reached, risk, opinion, explain, and execute all run. Opinion changes lots only in veto mode, and only downward.

7 Simulation and orders

Backtests walk the strategy rules on end-of-day closes. Charges use the cost profile and, when the trade date is known, the STT and exchange schedules. Without imported NSE data, the bundled sample is used and the report says so.

Orders go through `backend/app/trading/orders.py` for paper and live. Hedges are sent before short legs. An unfilled order is cancelled and re-priced within `MAX_SLIPPAGE_BPS`. A failed entry unwinds filled legs and halts. With protective stops enabled, each filled short leg gets a broker stop-limit wider than the strategy stop.

8 Database diagram



Research head is Alembic `0006_paper_orders`. Live head is `0005_broker_credentials`. The market database has no Alembic revision. Column definitions are in `CURRENT_DATABASE_ARCHITECTURE.md`.

9 Data model and lifecycle

Table group	Purpose
strategies, strategy_versions, ingest_runs	Identity, immutable text, extract record
reports, simulation_runs, sim_trades	One review and its trades
trade_reviews, strategy_improvements, improvement_decisions	Reviews and human decisions
paper_orders	Manual paper orders from the markets screen
audit_events	Research hash chain
deployed_strategies, deployments, deployment_events	Frozen approval and status
trade_intents, orders, order_events, fills, live_trades	Decisions and broker activity
capital_events, drawdown_events, position_snapshots	Money, ladder, marks
trade_opinions, phantom_trades, live_trade_reviews	LLM comments and lessons
broker_credentials, crew_heartbeats, live_audit_events	Secrets, liveness, live audit
index_bars, option_eod, import_files, market_events, news_items	Reference data

`strategies` can be updated and cannot be deleted. Every other research and live table rejects update and delete in the ORM and with database triggers. A review correction is a new row. Credential rotation is a new row. Market rows may be updated. Importers skip a file whose sha256 is already in `import_files`.

10 Review and evaluation

Check	What it decides	Where it is stored
Scenario verdict	Whether the fixed windows passed after costs	`reports.verdict_label`
Hard-stop sweep	A recommended capital stop	`reports.payload`
Trade review	Process verdict and mistake tags	`trade_reviews`
Approval backtest	Rules only versus rules with policy and ladder	Returned by the API. Not a report row
Opinion evaluation	Rules versus following the opinion, after enough samples	Computed by `GET /api/live/opinions/evaluation`

There is no RAGAS score and no latency SLO in this repository. `OPINION_EVAL_MIN_SAMPLES` defaults to 30 before an opinion comparison is treated as having enough closed samples.

11 Deployment design and configuration

Piece	How it runs
API	`uvicorn app.main:app` on port 8841
UI	`npm run dev -- -p 8842`
Trade Crew	`python -m app.agents.trade_crew` or `python -m app.live supervise`
Supervisor service	`backend/deploy/com.genesis.supervisor.plist` or `genesis-supervisor.service`

There is no Dockerfile and no compose file. PostgreSQL is supported for the research and live URLs. The `psycopg` driver is not declared in `backend/pyproject.toml`.

Unset variables use the defaults in `Settings`. A copied `.env.example` overrides capital, lots, portfolio caps, and the common risk rules. The table is in `CURRENT_SYSTEM_ARCHITECTURE_ANALYSIS.md`. Strategy frontmatter overrides cost and size. For common risk keys, the stricter of the environment value and the strategy value wins.

12 Deployment and operations runbook

1. Copy `.env.example` to `.env`. Set `LLM_PROVIDER` and one API key only if extract or opinions should call a model. The demo fixture runs without a key.

2. From `backend/`, run `uv sync`, `uv run alembic upgrade head`, and `uv run alembic -n live upgrade head`.

3. Start the API on port 8841 and the UI on port 8842.

4. Import NSE data, events, and holidays before relying on backtests or blackouts. Without them, simulations use the sample and a blackout rule blocks entries.

5. Create a paper account, preview the rules, confirm `rules_sha256`, and approve. Then start the deployment and run the supervisor or one crew process.

6. For live mode, set `API_TOKENS`, `BROKER_CREDENTIALS_KEY`, `LIVE_TRADING_ENABLED`, and a live-capable adapter. This repository does not include that adapter. Sandbox can exercise the gates when `SANDBOX_ALLOW_LIVE=true`.

Halt, missed heartbeats, floor pauses, and a kill switch that fails to cancel or flatten send alerts when Telegram or SMTP is configured. A failed alert is logged and does not block trading.

13 Functional and integration test plan

The automated suite is `uv run pytest` in `backend/`. Tests migrate temporary SQLite files, so the append-only triggers run. They do not call a real LLM, a real broker, or the network.

Area	What the tests cover
Research schema	Versioning, immutability, audit chain, journal, import
Markets and clarify	Yahoo parsing, paper charges and netting, clarifying questions
Review	Rules, costs, hard-stop sweep, improvements
Trade Crew	Entry, exits, blocked intents, tampered snapshots, kill switch
Money	Drawdown ladder, capital floor, withdrawal, odds gate, policy
Live plumbing	Sandbox orders, margin, protective stops, credentials, auth, supervisor

A release check is: migrations apply, `GET /api/health` returns, the demo run writes a report, audit verify passes, and a paper approval is refused when Gaps are present. The demo strategy omits `short_distance` and cannot be approved.

14 Checks the code enforces

Check	Gate
Audit	Both verify routes recompute the hash chain and report the first broken row
Money	Amounts are `Numeric(18, 4)`
Approval	Parsed rules, empty Gaps, matching `confirm_rules_sha256`, a completed report, actor or token, matching account mode, no other active deployment of that strategy in that mode
Live approval	`LIVE_TRADING_ENABLED`, registered live broker, credentials, structure on `LIVE_ALLOWED_STRUCTURES`, and `LIVE_MIN_PAPER_DAYS` when set
Crew	Hash mismatch, position mismatch, or a failed order halts the deployment
Secrets	Credential routes never return the stored value

These are code gates. They are not measured latency or accuracy percentages.

15 Limitations and source register

Limitations

- No Zerodha, Upstox, Dhan, or Angel One adapter is registered.
- Report verdicts do not replay the strategy `rules:` block. The approval backtest does.
- Protective stops are per short leg and wider than the strategy stop. A gap can pass the limit.
- SQLite allows one writer. Several crews on SQLite will contend. PostgreSQL is the documented alternative.
- The credential key sits on the same host as the database.
- Reconciliation halts on any manual trade in the account.
- Daily broker login is manual.
- Langfuse is not integrated.
- PDF ingest is rejected.
- Market quotes come from Yahoo's unofficial API. They are delayed, can break without notice, and have no MCX data. Paper option positions are not marked.

Source register

Source	Use in this report
DocumentsAndDiagrams/Readme.md	Problem statement and goals
CURRENT_SYSTEM_ARCHITECTURE_ANALYSIS.md	Components, API, configuration precedence
CURRENT_DATABASE_ARCHITECTURE.md	Tables, revisions, relationships
DATABASE_TABLE_REFERENCE.md	Writers and readers
LIBRARIES_AND_DEPENDENCIES.md	Libraries and unused declarations
backend/README.md	Operator procedures and live gates
diagrams/architecture.svg	Section 4
diagrams/workflow.svg	Section 6
diagrams/database.svg	Section 8

Analysis date: 10 October 2026. Schema claims come from the ORM and the Alembic heads. No live database was opened to produce this report.